

LAKSHMI A

Disaster Recovery Analyst

☎ 314-898-5499 | ✉ lakshmi.bcdr@gmail.com

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE:

Experienced IT Disaster Recovery (ITDR) Analyst with a strong background in disaster recovery planning, business impact analysis, and leveraging tools like ServiceNow to ensure business continuity. Proficient in coordinating failover and failback exercises, conducting compliance audits, and improving organizational resilience through strategic planning and execution.

- 5+ years of experience in **IT Disaster Recovery (ITDR)** and **Business Continuity (BCDR)**.
- Proven expertise in developing and implementing disaster recovery frameworks for diverse industries, including banking/finance.
- Adept at conducting Business Impact Analyses (BIA) to identify critical systems and optimize recovery efforts.
- Skilled in leveraging tools like **ServiceNow** to streamline disaster recovery workflows and incident management.
- Expertise in **Business Impact Analysis (BIA)**: Conducted BIAs for 50+ business processes, identifying critical systems and reducing overall potential downtime by 30%.
- Strong communicator with a track record of collaborating across departments to ensure organizational resilience.
- Acted as the primary DR Coordinator during a data center outage, recovering critical systems within 2 hours and minimizing business impact.
- **DR Testing and Simulation**: Led quarterly DR testing for 20+ applications, achieving a 75% success rate in **failover** and **failback** operations, includes tabletop exercises and simulation exercises.
- Proficient in managing audits and ensuring compliance with industry standards and regulatory requirements.

EDUCATION:

Southeast Missouri State University - Missouri, USA

Master of Science (Major: Applied Computer Science)

Bapatla Women's Engineering College - Bapatla, India

Bachelor's in technology (Major: Electronics and Communication Engineering)

WORK HISTORY:

Navient Corporation

IT Disaster Recovery Analyst

Indianapolis, USA

Jan 2024 – Till date

Responsibilities:

- Designed and maintained Disaster Recovery (DR) Plans to ensure operational continuity during disruptions.
- Developed and maintained comprehensive disaster recovery plans for critical IT systems, ensuring 99.9% recovery time objective (RTO) and recovery point objective (RPO) compliance.
- Performed risk assessments and BIAs for 50+ business processes, identifying critical systems and reducing potential downtime by 30%.
- Led quarterly DR testing for 20+ applications, achieving a 75% success rate in failover and failback operations

- Participated in cross-departmental tabletop exercises to validate DR strategies and refine response protocols.
- Ensured compliance with industry regulations by conducting periodic audits and updating DR policies accordingly.
- Migrated on-premises DR infrastructure to a hybrid cloud model, reducing recovery time by 40% and cutting costs by 25%.
- Acted as the primary resource during a data center outage, recovering critical systems within 2 hours and minimizing business impact.
- Conducted DR training sessions for 100+ employees, improving organizational readiness and reducing response time during disaster.

Key Achievement: Spearheaded the development of an automated emergency notification system, improving response times during incidents by 40%.

Charter Communications
Disaster Recovery Analyst

Saint Louis, USA
Jun 2023 – Dec 2023

Responsibilities:

- Conducted regular failover and failback exercises to create awareness for responsible teams and to validate RTO and RPO of the application.
- Developed and implemented Disaster Recovery (DR) strategies leveraging cloud services to ensure high availability and resilience of critical business applications.
- Designed robust failback mechanisms for hybrid cloud environments, ensuring seamless restoration of services with minimal downtime.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to assess recovery readiness, focusing on dependencies between AWS-hosted and on-premises applications.
- Enhanced DR capabilities by automating Recovery Time Objective (RTO) validations and Recovery Point Objective (RPO) tracking through customized dashboards.
- Collaborated with IT and business units to address recovery gaps in legacy systems.
- Designed and implemented risk mitigation strategies, enhancing operational resilience.
- Conducted root cause analysis for DR incidents, identifying gaps and implementing corrective actions to improve future recovery processes.
- Partnered with cybersecurity teams to integrate DR plans with incident response protocols, ensuring alignment during cyberattacks.

Key Achievement: Reduced recovery time for critical applications by 25% through the implementation of automated failover scripts and cloud-based DR solutions.

ANZ Operations and Technology Pvt Ltd
Disaster Recovery Analyst

Bangalore, India
Sep 2020 – Nov 2022

Responsibilities:

- Led the annual refresh of DR Plans and executed DR testing, including full Data Center failover/failback exercises.
- Designed a BCDR framework tailored for the banking sector, addressing unique challenges such as high transaction volumes and seasonal spikes.
- Conducted data center-level failover and failback tests, ensuring minimal downtime during disruptions.
- Integrated ServiceNow into the DR program, automating workflows and improving documentation accuracy.
- Organized scenario-based tabletop exercises to prepare teams for various disaster scenarios, including cyberattacks and hardware failures.

- Updated and tested Recovery Time Objectives (RTOs) and Recovery Point Objectives (RPOs) for over 100 applications.
- Partnered with cloud service providers to evaluate and enhance disaster recovery capabilities.
- Delivered real-time incident impact assessments and coordinated immediate recovery actions.
- Created and distributed DR awareness materials to increase preparedness among stakeholders.
- Represented the organization during third-party audits, achieving a 90% compliance rate.
- Developed a centralized DR dashboard using Power BI, providing real-time visibility into recovery metrics and compliance status.
- Streamlined DR documentation processes, reducing update cycle time by 20%.

Key Achievement: Conducted DR drills for critical banking applications, ensuring zero downtime during peak transaction periods.

ANZ Support Services Pvt Ltd
BCDR Consultant

Bangalore, India
Jun 2019 – Aug 2020

Responsibilities:

- Led annual refreshes of Disaster Recovery Plans for enterprise-level banking systems, ensuring they met regulatory requirements.
- Conducted large-scale failover/failback drills, simulating real-world disaster scenarios to validate recovery processes.
- Engaged in vendor security assessments, incorporating DR-specific requirements into contracts.
- Provided post-incident analysis and recommendations to improve future disaster recovery efforts.
- Coordinated with business units to develop application-specific DR plans, ensuring business continuity during disruptions.
- Conducted training sessions and workshops to improve organizational awareness of disaster recovery protocols.
- Collaborated with infrastructure and application teams to implement risk-reduction measures across critical systems.
- Played a key role in the establishment of an enterprise-wide DR steering committee.

CERTIFICATIONS:

ISO 22301—Business Continuity Management (BCM & BCP)

TECHNICAL SKILLS:

- **DR Tools:** ServiceNow, RSA Archer, Fusion
- **Backup Solutions:** MS SQL Server Backup, Azure Backup
- **Incident Management Tools:** Jira, Cherwell
- **Documentation Tools:** Microsoft office Suite, Visio, MS Excel
- **Visualization & Monitoring Tools:** Microsoft Power BI, Data Dog, Splunk
- **Database Management:** Microsoft SQL Server, Teradata SQL Assistant
- **Cloud Platforms:** Azure Site Recovery functionality, Azure, AWS
- **Programming Language:** Python